

Lea Nassal

CONTACT

Management School, University of Liverpool

Mail: Lea.Nassal@liverpool.ac.uk

Website: www.leanassal.com

RESEARCH FIELDS

Primary: Labor Economics

Secondary: Health Economics, Applied Microeconomics

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

University of Liverpool 2026-

Assistant Professor

University of Warwick 2024 - 2026

Postdoctoral Research Fellow

AFFILIATIONS

Rockwool Foundation Berlin 2026 -

Research Affiliate

EDUCATION

University of Duisburg-Essen 2024

Ph.D. Economics

University of Bonn 2017-2019

M.Sc. Economics

University of Bonn 2014-2017

B.Sc. Economics

VISITING

Tilburg University Spring 2023

WORKING PAPERS

Job Loss and Retirement - R&R at the *Journal of Labor Economics*

Abstract: This paper provides the first evidence of the long-term effects of job loss on age at retirement, pension benefits and lifetime income. Exploiting plant closures and using German administrative data, I compare displaced workers with similar non-displaced workers. I show that displaced workers delay their retirement in response to the shock and ineligibility for early pension claims is the main driver of this response. Despite adjustments in retirement behavior, displaced workers face significant losses in pension benefits and lifetime income. Compared to similar non-displaced workers, displaced workers experience losses in the present discounted value of their lifetime income of 25%.

Moving to Opportunity, Together

with Seema Jayachandran, Matthew Notowidigdo, Marie Paul, Heather Sarsons and Elin Sundberg

Abstract: Many couples face a trade-off between advancing one spouse's career or the other's. We study this trade-off using administrative data from Germany and Sweden. Using an event study approach, we find that when couples move across commuting zones, men's earnings increase more than women's. To distinguish between men's greater potential earnings and a gender norm that prioritizes men's careers, we examine how the patterns differ when the woman has higher potential earnings than her husband. We then estimate a model of household decision-making in which households can (and do) place more weight on income earned by the man.

Primum Non Nocere? Mortality Effects of a Physician Strike in Germany

with Daniel Avdic, Martin Karlsson and Nina Schwarz

Abstract: We study the consequences of a protracted and unanticipated physician strike in German university hospitals on patient mortality. To estimate the causal effect of the strike, we compare striking and non-striking hospitals in a difference-in-differences design using a comprehensive dataset of all hospital admissions in Germany linked to newly collected records of strike participation. Our results show that the strike led to a sharp decrease in hospital admissions and a significant increase in hospital mortality in striking hospitals. Applying a double selection LASSO algorithm to adjust for care rationing and patient selection, we show that around half of the mortality effect of the strike can be attributed to quality-of-care factors. Finally, we find spillover effects on admissions to nearby non-striking hospitals but no corresponding impact on hospital mortality. We conclude that prolonged industrial action in the healthcare sector may have severe consequences for patient safety unless appropriate risk mitigation protocols are established.

WORK IN PROGRESS

The "Price" of Breaking the Glass Ceiling

with Sonia Bhalotra and Rita Ginja

Mental Health and Crime

with Sonia Bhalotra, Meltem Daysal and Mircea Trandafir

PRESENTATIONS

2026

CY Cergy Paris Université, CERGE-EI (Prague), Interdisciplinary Conference on Acknowledging Sexual Violence: Policy, Practice and Voice (London), University of Potsdam, University of Leeds, Newcastle University (online), Royal Holloway Workshop on the Economics of Health and Human Capital (London), University of Liverpool, University of St Andrews (online)

2025

IZA/Leiden University/OECD Workshop: Recent Advances in Labor Economics Using Linked Employer-Employee Data (Leiden), Wellbeing, Health, and Human Behaviour Conference (Warwick), SOLE-EALE Annual Meeting (Toronto), RHUL-City University Family and Health Economics Research Workshop (London), Annual Meeting of the German Economic Association (Cologne)

2024

SOLE Annual Meeting (Portland), 10th IRDES Workshop on Applied Health Economics and Policy Evaluation (Paris), University of Bergen, Vienna University of Business and Economics, IWH Halle, Rockwool Foundation Berlin (online)

2023

EALE Annual Meeting (Prague), Essen Health Conference, RES and SES Annual Conference (Glasgow), GSS Seminar (Tilburg University), SEG Seminar (Tilburg University), Ph.D. Workshop Royal Holloway (London)

2022

SOLE Annual Meeting (Minneapolis), 2nd Berlin Workshop on Empirical Public Economics: Gender Economics (Berlin), EEA-ESEM Annual Congress (Milan), DFG conference "The German Labor Market in a Globalized World: Trade, Technology, and Demographics" (Mannheim), Annual Conference of the European Society of Population Economics (ESPE) (Rende), Spring Meeting Young Economists (Orléans)

2021

Annual Meeting of the German Economic Association (virtual), 7th Potsdam PhD Workshop in Empirical Economics (virtual), EEA-ESEM Annual Congress (virtual), BeNA Labor Economics Workshop (virtual), 1st Annual Southern PhD Economics Conference (virtual), 13th RGS Doctoral Conference (virtual)

POLICY & MEDIA OUTPUTS

Gender, Career Opportunities, and Relocation Decisions of Couples, NBER Digest, 2024.

Who Matters More in a Move: The Husband or the Wife? Wall Street Journal, 2024.

Moving to Opportunity Together, BFI Research Briefs, 2024.

REFEREEING

American Economic Review: Insights, Demography, Industrial Relations, Journal of Development Studies, Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization

TEACHING

Econometrics (Master Business Administration), University of Duisburg-Essen Lecturer	2023
Macroeconomics (Bachelor), University of Duisburg-Essen Teaching Assistant to Marie Paul	2022, 2024
Seminar Economics (Bachelor), University of Duisburg-Essen Teaching Assistant to Jens Wrona	2022-2024
Supervision of Bachelor's theses, University of Duisburg-Essen	2020-2024

MISCELLANEOUS

Languages

German (native), English (fluent), French (intermediate)

Software

Stata, R, ArcGIS, L^AT_EX

Last updated on September 4, 2026